How to Ace Your YC Application

This is a worksheet to guide you through the 4 Core Questions. In the AWS workshop, we will review each question and the proposed way to answer each question. Please review the questions and the tips justified to the right.

Describe what your company does in 50 character or less.

Tips

- Be concise
- Focus on the tangible customer value
- Use market substitutes or widely known co's like "Uber for X"

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

Answer in three parts

1. What are you building? "Company is building X for Y to do Z"
2. Why should product exist? "Historically/Traditionally/ Currently, customers did X"
3. What is your value prop? "Now, customers now can use X to do…"

Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?

How to Answer - Focus on your unique insight and only one of the below themes

- Personal Experience
- Professional Experience
- Domain Expertise

What's new about what you're making? What substitutes do people resort to because it doesn't exist yet (or they don't know it)?

Answer in three parts

1. Work backward from your customer and identify their needs
2. How are their needs not being met
3. How your company will solve their painpoint